

Urinary system

Your body's cells release poisonous waste products. Many are flushed out of the body by the urinary system. Two kidneys process your body's blood and remove excess water and waste. This waste liquid, called urine (pee), is carried to the bladder, and released from the body via the urethra when you go to the bathroom.

FILLING THE BLADDER

The kidneys produce urine. It is then pushed by waves of muscle contraction along the two ureters to the bladder. Urine is stored in the bladder until the bladder sends messages to the brain indicating that it needs to be emptied. Urine then flows out of the body along the urethra.

► LONG AND SHORT

In the female system (shown here), urine is expelled out of the body through a short urethra. The male system is the same except that the urethra is longer and passes along the penis.

